NATIONAL SENIOR CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION
NOVEMBER 2025

ENGLISH HOME LANGUAGE: PAPER I

MARKING GUIDELINES

Time: 3 hours 100 marks

These marking guidelines are prepared for use by examiners and sub-examiners, all of whom are required to attend a standardisation meeting to ensure that the guidelines are consistently interpreted and applied in the marking of candidates' scripts.

The IEB will not enter any discussions or correspondence about any marking guidelines. It is acknowledged that there may be different views about some matters of emphasis or detail in the guidelines. It is also recognised that, without the benefit of attendance at a standardisation meeting, there may be different interpretations of the application of the marking guidelines.

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The Marking Guidelines are to be used in conjunction with the Generic Descriptors.

QUESTION 1 COMPREHENSION

1.1 The title, 'The Meaning of Life – Who Cares?', reflects a dismissive/careless/ questioning attitude towards the traditional pursuit of life's meaning. The casual/informal use of 'Who Cares?' suggests that the writer finds the constant search for a definitive answer unnecessary or even counter-productive, highlighting a preference for living life fully rather than obsessing over its purpose.

[Candidates should identify the attitude and provide an explanation to be awarded 2 marks.]

1.2 The metaphor of life as a 'puzzle to solve' conveys the rigid and overly analytical approach many take when searching for meaning. By contrasting this with 'a journey to explore', the writer emphasises the importance of embracing life's uncertainties and experiences. The writer juxtaposes the rigidity of the puzzle to the uncertainty of the journey. The metaphors are effective as they simplify complex ideas, making the argument relatable and encouraging readers to adopt a more open, exploratory mindset.

[Candidates need to discuss both metaphors for full marks. Candidates who discuss only one metaphor cannot earn more than 2 marks.]

1.3 The writer critiques society's role in creating unrealistic expectations, arguing that societal pressures impose a narrow view of a meaningful life. Through phrases like 'obvious, measurable meaning' and 'unrealistic expectations', the writer positions the reader to view society as a source of stress and conformity. The reader might be positioned to view society with contempt, disdain, or suspicion. This challenges readers to question societal norms and prioritise their unique values.

[Candidates must refer to a specific positioning word and give specific justification to achieve full marks. Candidates who do not use a specific positioning word cannot be awarded more than 2½ marks.]

1.4 The rhetorical questions in paragraph 4, encourage readers to reflect on their own beliefs. By posing these questions, the writer invites introspection, subtly challenging readers to reconsider the necessity of defining life's purpose. This technique also reinforces the writer's argument that life should be lived authentically and without over-analysis.

[Candidates must link the use of rhetorical questions to the content of the article: questioning the definition of life's purposes. Candidates who merely suggest that the rhetorical questions are to make the reader question themselves cannot be awarded more than 2 marks.]

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1.5 The tone in these paragraphs is reflective/questioning/optimistic. Words like 'authentically', 'happiness', 'complexity', and 'beauty' convey a sense of appreciation for life's diversity. These words emphasise the writer's belief in embracing individual experiences and rejecting rigid societal definitions, creating a tone that is both empowering and encouraging. Similarly, her use of 'pressures' associated with society focuses the reader's attention on how she understands society's role in forcing individuals to follow the trend and give up on their individuality. The reflective/optimistic tone helps create an open, accepting atmosphere that supports the writer's intention to question rigid beliefs and promote personal authenticity.

[To be awarded full marks, candidates must use a specific tone word that is linked to the writer's intention.]

1.6 The figure of speech is a simile. By comparing 'meaning' to 'beauty', the writer illustrates that both are personal and open to interpretation. This simile reinforces the argument that life's meaning varies from person to person, emphasising individuality and rejecting universal definitions. The simile is effective as it reminds the reader that meaning and beauty are in the eye of the beholder.

[Candidates can receive 1 mark for identifying the figure of speech as a simile. The comment on the effectiveness of the simile is awarded 2 marks according to the 2-mark descriptor.]

1.7 The writer suggests that life's meaning is not fixed or unchanging but evolves with our experiences and perspectives. Rather than striving for a single, permanent purpose, individuals should accept that meaning shifts over time and is shaped by personal growth.

[Candidates must explain this in their own words, maintaining the writer's meaning.]

1.8 Emily O'Neil would likely view Uncle Sol's life as an example of individuality and the diversity of meaning in human existence. In **TEXT 1**, O'Neil argues that life's value lies in authenticity and personal experiences, not societal approval. The poem's depiction of Uncle Sol's failures ('born failure', 'the skunks caught cold and died') highlights his unconventional path, yet his life still elicits emotion and impact ('we all cried like the Missouri').

O'Neil might appreciate how Uncle Sol lived uniquely, aligning with her idea that meaning is subjective and not defined by success or societal standards. She would encourage the speaker in 'nobody loses all the time' to applaud the celebration of his individuality, as reflected in the funeral's 'scrumptious' and 'splendiferous' elements, which underscore his distinct impact on those around him. Similarly, O'Neil refers to the risks associated with 'over-analysing life' being that we 'risk losing its complexity and beauty'. Uncle Sol 'indulged' in life and as a result it could be suggested that Uncle Sol was respected.

*[Candidates must refer to diction from **TEXT 1** and 'nobody loses all the time' equally to earn full marks. Candidates who refer to one text only cannot be awarded more than 2 marks.]*

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QUESTION 2 SUMMARY

Global marking, giving credit for concise and coherent sentences expressed in the candidate's own words.

Very good	Good	Average	Below average	Very weak
10	8	6½	5	3
9	7½	6	4½	2
8½	7	5½	4	1

Very good: (10–8½)

- Candidates producing a very good summary, **which has adhered to all instructions**, demonstrate they can successfully select relevant information from the different parts of the texts.
- Candidates expertly synthesise that information to suit the new context and fulfil the specific requirements of the summary task.
- **The register is consistently appropriate [for the format]**, and the summary will stand alone as a successful, cohesive text.
- Expression will be excellent and will demonstrate a mastery of the language.
- Full and coherent sentences are used, resulting in a well-crafted, stylistically superior text.
- A summary in this category that exceeds the word limit can be awarded a maximum of 8½ marks.

Good: (8–7)

- A candidate producing a good summary is able to discern which aspects of the texts are relevant, synthesise these, and convey them in his/her own words.
- **The summary successfully meets most of the requirements specified in the instructions.**
- Candidates **use the appropriate register [for the format]**, which is well sustained throughout the summary.
- The expression in such summaries demonstrates clarity that is not evident in the average summary.
- Full and coherent sentences are used and are well sustained throughout the summary.
- A summary in this category that exceeds the word limit can be awarded a maximum of 7 marks.

Average: (6½–5½)

- A candidate producing an average summary demonstrates an ability to discern which aspects of the texts are relevant and can put these into his/her own words most of the time.
- **The summary might not take into consideration the most important requirements specified in the instructions.**
- There may be instances of lifting or lapses that display faulty selection, incorrect emphasis, or difficulty with synthesis.
- **The register is mostly appropriate [for the format]**, although minor lapses may occur.
- Expression is merely competent, and there may be lapses in the construction of full sentences.
- A summary in this category that exceeds the word limit can be awarded a maximum of 5½ marks.

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Below average: (5–4)

- A candidate producing a below-average summary demonstrates an ability, some of the time, to discern which parts of the texts are relevant, but may not be able to effectively put this into his/her own words.
- In some instances, large sections of the original texts are lifted and reproduced.
- **It is likely that the register is not appropriate [for the format]** or that the new text does not meet the requirements of the task.
- Expression is likely flawed but does not impede understanding.
- A summary in this category that exceeds the word limit can be awarded a maximum of 4 marks.

Very weak: (3–1)

- Summaries in this category show extremely limited, if any, understanding of the texts.
- This is evident through an inability to select appropriate parts of the texts to summarise or through excessive cutting and pasting.
- **Register is not appropriate [for the format].**
- Expression is likely poor, impeding understanding.

NOTE:

- Penalise from 94 words onwards by moving the mark to the bottom of the category (see descriptors). Write words from the descriptor to indicate your thinking.
- Stop reading at 100 words.
- Subtract 1 mark:
  - if no word count is provided, OR
  - if an inexcusably inaccurate word count has been provided.

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QUESTION 3 SEEN POETRY

3.1 The punctuation in these lines is: two commas, a semicolon, and a full stop. The punctuation reflects the speaker's pauses and hesitations, mirroring their emotional struggle with the idea of parting. The comma in 'When you can no more hold me by the hand, / Nor I half turn to go yet turning stay' conveys the tension between leaving and lingering, emphasising the difficulty of separation. The punctuation slows the rhythm, creating a reflective and mournful tone that underscores the depth of the speaker's emotions as evidenced in lines 1–2 '… away, / Gone …' and lines 3–4 '… hand, / Nor …'. The full stop in line 4 '… stay' reflects the finality of the thought, emphasising her passing.

[Candidates need not refer to all of the punctuation in these lines, but must refer to specific examples linking them to meaning.]

3.2 The pronouns 'you' and 'me' emphasise the apostrophe and create a direct and intimate connection between the speaker and the listener, making the plea deeply personal. The possessive adjective 'our' in 'our future' highlights the shared bond and mutual plans, emphasising the emotional weight of their impending separation. This language makes the speaker's request for remembrance heartfelt and poignant.

[Candidates can refer to the pronouns and the possessive adjective collectively. They do not need to give specific details, but must link them to the speaker's emotions.]

3.3 The word 'vestige', meaning a trace of something that no longer exists, effectively conveys the speaker's view of death as a state where only faint remnants of one's life and thoughts remain. It suggests that after death, a person's essence fades, but small, intangible traces might linger. This aligns with the speaker's hope that their memory will leave a faint but meaningful impression on the listener even if the speaker is forgotten.

[Candidates must refer to their understanding of 'vestige' and link it to the writer's view of death.]

3.4 The lines are bittersweet because they juxtapose the sadness of being forgotten with the comfort of the listener finding happiness. The speaker prioritises the listener's emotional well-being over their own desire to be remembered, showcasing selflessness and acceptance. This duality of loss and love imbues the lines with a poignant yet comforting tone.

[Candidates should show an implied understanding of 'bittersweet' in their response. Candidates who do not show this understanding cannot achieve more than 1½ marks.]

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3.5 Both poets use the sonnet form to explore inner conflict and self-awareness while ultimately addressing and resolving emotional struggles.

In 'Remember', Christina Rosetti uses the traditional Petrarchan sonnet structure to portray a deeply personal reflection on mortality and remembrance. The octave begins with the plea, 'Remember me when I am gone away / Gone far away into the silent land' introducing the speaker's inner conflict between the desire to be remembered and the inevitability of death. The volta at line 9 marks a shift in tone: 'Yet if you should forget me for a while / And afterwards remember, do not grieve'. This self-awareness allows the speaker to resolve their emotional struggle, prioritising the listener's happiness over their own need for remembrance. The closing lines, 'Better by far you should forget and smile / Than that you should remember and be sad' reflect a bittersweet acceptance, highlighting the speaker's growth and emotional resolution.

In 'Ozymandias of Egypt', Percy Bysshe Shelley employs the sonnet to critique human hubris and explore the transience of power. The narrative structure, framed by a traveller's account, focuses on the remnants of a once-mighty king: 'Two vast and trunkless legs of stone / Stand in the desert'. The octave presents the shattered visage of Ozymandias, with its 'sneer of cold command' and the inscription proclaiming, 'My name is Ozymandias, king of kings: / Look on my works, ye Mighty, and despair!' The volta shifts attention to the surrounding emptiness: 'Nothing beside remains. Round the decay / Of that colossal wreck, boundless and bare / The lone and level sands stretch far away'. Shelley uses this transition to resolve the poem's conflict, highlighting the futility of seeking permanence in worldly achievements. The decay of Ozymandias's works becomes a metaphor for the impermanence of human endeavours, reflecting a profound self-awareness about humanity's vulnerability to time.

Both sonnets align with Paul Oppenheimer's assertion that the form provides 'a way to reflect on human nature' and resolve 'emotional struggles'. In 'Remember', the speaker resolves the tension between love and loss, embracing a selfless perspective on remembrance. In 'Ozymandias', Shelley addresses the human tendency toward arrogance, ultimately emphasising humility and the inevitability of decay. These reflective resolutions, achieved through the structure and content of the sonnet, demonstrate the poets' mastery in exploring inner conflict and achieving emotional clarity.

[Candidates must show a clear understanding of the sonnet forms, and how each poet uses them to make their meaning clear. They must refer to both poems and the extract for full marks. Candidates who do not refer to both poems cannot be awarded more than 3 marks. ***No half marks are awarded for this question.****]*

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QUESTION 4 UNSEEN POETRY

4.1 The metaphor, 'Fog blankets the desolate earth', evokes a sense of calm and stillness, as if nature is being comforted or tucked in. This soft visual is extended by 'motionless, invisible arms', which gives the fog a human-like tenderness, heightening its gentle presence. The phrase 'Gentle as the sweetest kiss / On tender lips' introduces a romantic and delicate comparison that appeals to the senses, enriching the reader's visual and emotional connection to the scene. Similarly, the 'vapor mist of moisture' is also a reference to a gentle/careful caressing of nature upon 'foliage' that links to the phrase 'Gentle as the sweetest kiss / On tender lips'.

[Candidates must refer to specific imagery and explain how it enhances the visual impact of these lines.]

4.2 The verbs 'Sipping' and 'Absorbing' convey continuous actions of deliberate and gentle intake. 'Sipping' implies a slow, careful process, emphasising the plant's dependence on rain, while 'Absorbing' evokes an image of urgent necessity, as if nature is eagerly drawing in nourishment. These words help readers visualise the nurturing relationship between rain and the earth.

[Candidates must refer to the present continuous nature of both actions, but they do not need the specific grammatical terms to be awarded full marks.]

4.3 'During the calm before the storm' (line 12) can be understood both literally and figuratively. Literally, it describes the stillness in nature before a rainstorm. Figuratively, it symbolises the balance in nature where peace precedes upheaval, suggesting that the nurturing power of rain might also lead to turbulence. This duality reflects the cyclical and unpredictable nature of the environment.

[Candidates can suggest that the line is best understood literally or figuratively, with a full explanation of either or both.]

4.4 The alliteration, 'Soaked, satisfied, Nature's call', draws attention to the interconnectedness of rain and nature. The repetition of the 's' sound (sibilance) mirrors the soothing rhythm of rainfall, emphasising the intimate and life-giving relationship between the rain and nature.

[Candidates must quote specific examples of alliteration for full marks and link them to the relationship between the rain and nature.]

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4.5 In 'Call of Nature' (**TEXT 4A**), personification is used to create a nurturing mood. Fog is described as having 'motionless, invisible arms' and rain 'Dampens foliage with care', portraying nature as a gentle, life-sustaining force. The imagery of rain as 'A miracle of unspoken prayer' further enhances the reverent mood.

In 'Namaqualand after Rain' (**TEXT 4B**), personification conveys the transformative power of rain. Roots 'explode in strings of stars', and 'Grass waves again', suggesting vibrancy and renewal. 'The desert sighs at dawn' creates an image of relief and revival. This personification heightens the mood of awe and celebration for nature's resilience.

Both poets effectively use personification to emphasise the life-giving and restorative power of rain, but 'Call of Nature' focuses on gentle harmony, while 'Namaqualand after Rain' captures dramatic renewal.

[Credit valid alternative responses. Candidates must give specific examples of personification and link them to examples of the mood in each poem. Candidates who refer only to one poem cannot achieve more than 2½ marks.]

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QUESTION 5 CRITICAL AND VISUAL LITERACY

5.1 The verbal details, 'EMPOWER, RESCUE, RESTORE', emphasise the transformative and active nature of Sunitha Krishnan's work. Each word conveys a distinct phase: 'EMPOWER' reflects giving strength and autonomy to victims; 'RESCUE' suggests direct action to remove victims from danger; and 'RESTORE' indicates rebuilding lives and dignity. Together, these terms highlight her comprehensive and compassionate approach to combating human trafficking.

[Candidates must discuss each word specifically. Candidates with a global understanding of the words cannot achieve more than 2 marks. The words must be linked to the importance of Sunitha Krishnan's work.]

5.2 5.2.1 Her work shines as a guiding light for survivors, igniting a spark of hope across society.

[Candidates could also punctuate the sentence with a semicolon, colon, or a dash instead of a comma. If candidates retain the full stop, the second sentence must have a subject: '…for survivors. It ignites a…]

5.2.2 The figure of speech is a metaphor, comparing Sunitha's work to a 'guiding light' and 'spark of hope'. While evocative, it is somewhat clichéd as such imagery is commonly used to describe inspirational efforts. However, the metaphors effectively communicate her role in providing direction and hope, making them suitable despite their familiarity.

[Candidates can be awarded 1 mark for identifying the metaphor, 1 mark for showing their understanding of a cliché, and 1 mark for their opinion. Candidates can argue that it is or is not clichéd. Candidates must identify a figure of speech.]

5.3 5.3.1 The hashtag '#societyunites' is both brand-relevant and emotionally resonant, effectively supporting the advertiser's message of unity and communal strength. It's a clever blend of product identity and social values.

[Candidates must show the effectiveness of the hashtag and link it to the purpose of the advertisement.]

5.3.2 'Apart' implies division and separation, reinforcing the message about societal issues that divide communities. In contrast, 'a part' would convey inclusion, which is not the intended meaning here.

[Candidates must discuss both 'apart' and 'a part'. They can be awarded 1 mark for each word.]

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5.4 The layout of **TEXT 5B** effectively portrays the seriousness of human trafficking. The sombre image of a jail-like room with bars and a metal bed centred in the image and set back behind the text creates a visual association with confinement and loss of freedom, echoing the reality faced by victims. The crest of the Canadian Human Trafficking Hotline lends credibility, while the bold statement 'Your job shouldn't be your jail' captures attention as it links employment to imprisonment. The varying/various font sizes and the placement of the text are key to our understanding of the seriousness of the situation. The placement of the hotline number and QR code ensures immediate access to help, emphasising urgency and support. The use of the pronouns 'you' and 'your' adds to the fostering of an appealing tone.

[Candidates do not need to unpack the specifics of the visual and verbal details but should refer to their placement. Those who only refer to one type cannot be awarded more than 2½ marks.]

5.5 5.5.1 The sentence, 'If this is happening to you, we are here to help', is a complex sentence because it consists of a main clause ('we are here to help') and a subordinate clause ('If this is happening to you') which begins with a subordinating conjunction.

[Candidates can earn 1 mark for correctly identifying the sentence as complex and 1 mark for an accurate explanation. They must be specific in their explanation of why it is a complex sentence.]

5.5.2 Reordering the sentence to 'We are here to help if this is happening to you' would diminish its effectiveness. The original order prioritises the conditional phrase, directly addressing victims' circumstances before offering help, which better aligns with the urgency of the message.

[Candidates must refer to the different foci of each sentence to earn full marks.]

5.6 The visualisation in **TEXT 5C** is effective. The use of stylised figures with contrasting colours (blue for men and pink for women) and the large '80%' statistic immediately conveys that most victims are female. This stark contrast is simple yet impactful, ensuring the statistic is memorable, albeit simplistic.

5.7 **TEXT 5D** combines minimalist design with a powerful metaphor. The phrase 'NOT FOR SALE' placed above a barcode immediately conveys the dehumanisation and commodification of trafficking victims. Below this, a short but impactful paragraph outlines the hidden nature of trafficking and identifies its many forms – from labour to domestic servitude – emphasising that it can happen 'even in your own community'. This is followed by a clear and urgent call to action: 'Don't look away. Report the signs. Raise your voice.' The inclusion of a hotline number and further prompts such as 'Learn the signs' and 'Be the change' empower the viewer with both information and agency. **TEXT 5D** not only informs but also compels the viewer to act.

[*Candidates must critically discuss why **TEXT 5D** is effective by referring to specific visual and verbal details.*

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QUESTION 6 LANGUAGE

6.1 The colon in the title separates the main topic, 'Oxford Word of the Year' from the specific word/phrase being discussed, '*Brain Rot*', to effectively introduce the subject.

6.2 The brackets provide additional clarification or detail ('now particularly online content') without interrupting the main flow of the sentence.

[Candidates' answers need to be in the context of the lines referenced.]

6.3 'Recovered and regained' is an example of tautology. Tautology refers to the unnecessary repetition of the same idea using different words. In this case, 'recovered' and 'regained' essentially convey the same meaning; both suggest returning to a previous state of importance or use. Therefore, it would be more concise to use only one term rather than both, since both express the same concept.

6.4 6.4.1 The split infinitive 'to mockingly describe' should be corrected to, 'to describe mockingly'.

[Candidates who correct the sentence but remove 'mockingly' can earn only a ½ mark.]

6.4.2 The writer should have used 'phenomenon' instead of 'phenomena' because 'phenomenon' is the singular form, whereas 'phenomena' is plural, and the context refers to a singular concept.

6.4.3 The hyphen in 'low-quality' links the two words, creating a compound adjective that modifies the noun 'content'.

[Candidates can only achieve a ½ mark if they state that the hyphen joins two words.]

6.4.4 The writer's use of 'perceived' implies that the harm caused by low-quality content may not be objectively proven but is instead a subjective opinion or belief.

6.5 6.5.1 'Its adoption by younger generations' is the subject.

[Candidates must provide the full subject to earn this mark. No marks can be awarded if they include any other information from the sentence.]

6.5.2 The error of concord is 'reveal' in 'those both consuming and creating digital content – reveal'. It should be corrected to 'reveals' to agree with the singular subject, 'adoption'. In ('Its adoption by younger…').

6.5.3 The writer should have used 'technology's role' instead of 'technologies role' because the possessive apostrophe is needed to indicate that the role belongs to technology.

Total: 100 marks

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DESCRIPTORS FOR EVALUATING RESPONSES DETERMINED BY MARK ALLOCATION AND COGNITIVE SKILL

A 5-mark question that requires extended abstract thinking. The response demonstrates understanding, application, analysis, complex inference and/or synthesis, evaluation, or appreciation.	
Marks	**Skills**
5	The excellent response: • is **complete and detailed**, making specific reference to more than one element of the required text(s). • **makes insightful links** between the question and the text(s). • **provides evidence** that understanding can be transferred to a new context. • **integrates all elements**, **making connections** and **demonstrating a clear understanding** of how the parts contribute to the whole.
4	The very good response: • **makes specific reference** to the required text(s). • makes **accurate links** between the question and the text(s). • provides evidence that **understanding** can be **applied to familiar contexts**. • **integrates the key elements, making connections and demonstrating a clear understanding** of how the parts contribute to the whole.
3	The average response: • refers to the required text(s) in a **general** way without addressing all aspects. • makes simple, **underdeveloped links** between the question and the text(s) • could be complete, without the required references or evidence. • **does not demonstrate an understanding** of the significance of the whole (does not clarify/establish the significance of the whole).
2	The incomplete response: • refers to the text(s) in a **general** way. • is **inaccurate or simplistic**. • demonstrates **concrete thinking** and an **incomplete understanding** of the elements.
1	The very partial response: • **refers to the text(s).** • does not answer the question because of a **lack of understanding**.
1–0	The inadequate response: • attempts to deal with only **one aspect of the question** but does so very poorly. • displays **very limited understanding**.

A 2-mark question that requires uni-structural thinking. Demonstrates understanding and application, literal comprehension, and reorganisation.	
Marks	**Skills**
2	The excellent response: • is **complete and accurate**.
1½	The good response: • is **partially complete and accurate**. or • is **complete and mostly accurate**.
1–0	The incomplete response: • includes only **one half of the required response or is inaccurate**.

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A 4-mark question that requires relational thinking. Demonstrates understanding, application, analysis, complex inference or synthesis. This answer could require evaluation or appreciation.	
Marks	**Skills**
4	The excellent response: • is complete, **addressing all aspects of the question** and drawing them together accurately. • **links** all the ideas and provides the required **evidence.** • demonstrates **understanding** applied to familiar contexts. • **integrates all elements**, making connections and **demonstrating a clear understanding** of how the parts contribute to the whole.
3½–3	The good response: • shows that the **significance of each element is understood**, but an aspect of the answer is **not clearly explained**. or • addresses each element but **does not successfully link them**. • is **not entirely convincing** and/or does not convey a clear understanding of how the parts contribute to the whole.
2½	The average response: • is **multi-structural but** addresses the elements in an **incomplete or flawed way**. • **does not link elements** or **demonstrate an understanding** of the significance of the elements. • **omits or misunderstands** a key element.
2	The incomplete response: • is **one-dimensional**, omitting more than one element. • indicates a **flawed understanding** of the question and/or the text.
1½	The very partial response: • attempts to address aspects of the question but indicates only **partial understanding**.
1–0	The inadequate response: • attempts to deal with **only one aspect** of the question but does so very poorly. • **very limited understanding** displayed.

A 3-mark question that requires multi-structural thinking. Demonstrates understanding, application, analysis, and inferential comprehension of implied and figurative meanings.	
Marks	**Skills**
3	The excellent response: • **engages with all aspects** of the question and **provides** the required evidence. • indicates a **clear understanding of the significance** of each element.
2½	The good response: • is multi-structural, but **not integrated**. or • is convincing but **incomplete**. • **provides evidence** if required.
2	The average response: • is either **one-dimensional**, without sufficient **evidence**, or **is superficial and general**. • does not provide enough **relevant justification**. • demonstrates that the candidate **understands the issue**.
1½	The incomplete response: • demonstrates a **flawed or incomplete understanding** of what has been asked. • indicates an **understanding** of the text. • **attempts to use the text(s)** to answer the question, but reasoning is concrete or simplistic.
1–0	The inadequate response: • indicates only **partial/limited/no understanding** of this aspect of the text.

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